CROSS-PLATFORM GAMING SYNTHESIS

Which Launch Strategy Maximizes Reach and Engagement?

131,884 games · 3 platforms · 60GB dataset · 6 analysis dimensions

Poi — Workintech Data Analyst Program — March 2026

THE QUESTION

If we were launching a game in 2025, which combination of platform strategy, pricing model, and target region maximizes player reach and engagement?

THESIS

Multi-platform releases reach more players, but single-platform games achieve deeper per-player engagement. The optimal strategy depends on whether the goal is reach or depth.

THE PIPELINE

19 RAW TABLES
55M+ rows

→

13 BRONZE TABLES
Cleaned & typed

→

7 SILVER TABLES
90M+ unified

→

14 GOLD TABLES
Analysis-ready

→

PYTHON NOTEBOOK
15 charts + 3 ML

THREE SUCCESS PROXIES

Library Presence
Acquisition · All 3 platforms

Achievement Completion
Retention · All 3 platforms

Review Reception
Advocacy · Steam only

PLATFORM LANDSCAPE

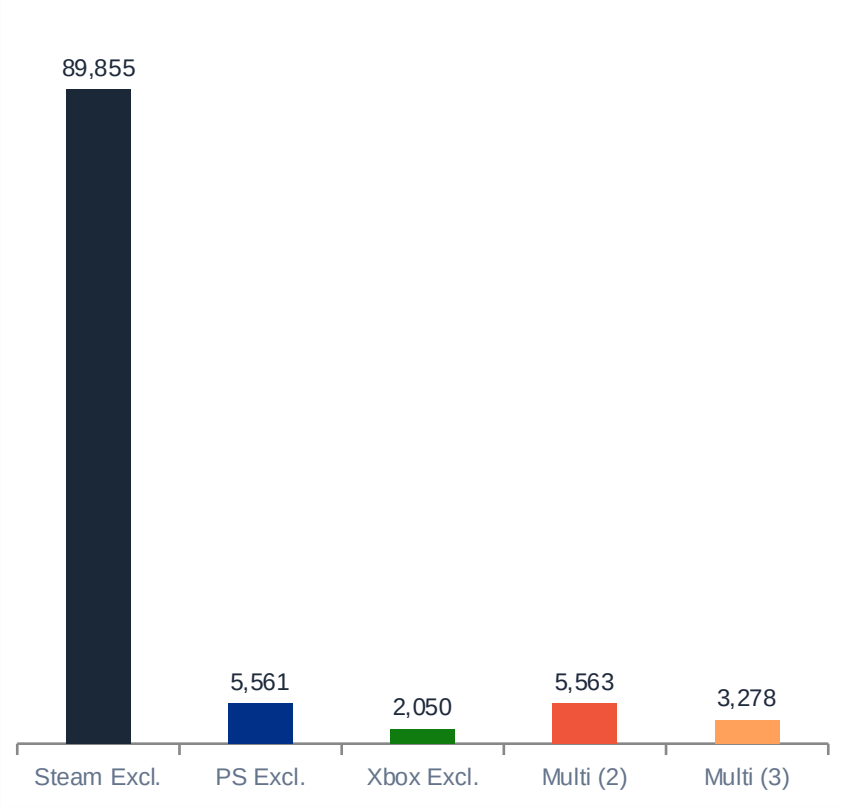
85.5%

of games never leave their platform

Only 8.4% of titles appear on 2+ platforms.

Steam alone: 89,855 exclusive titles.

Multi-platform publishing is the exception.



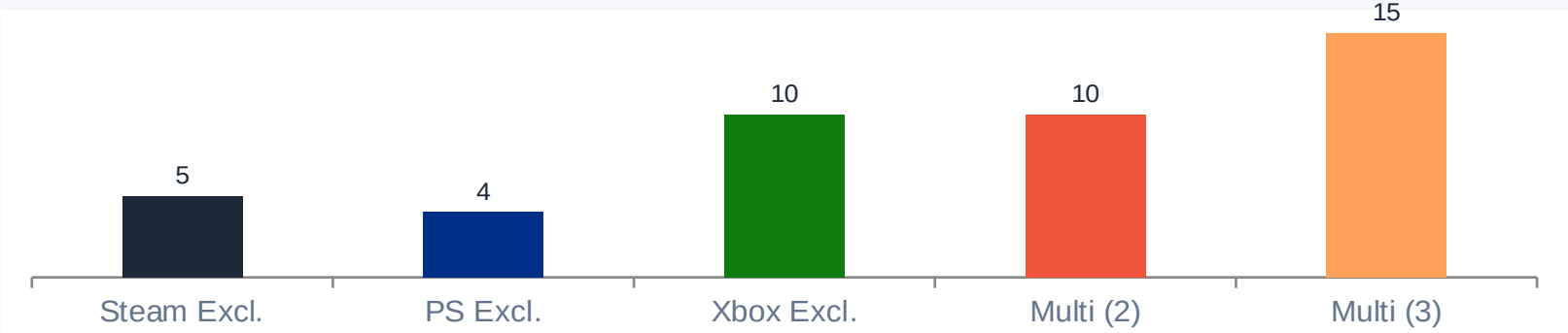
PRICING ANALYSIS

3×

Multi-platform price premium
$14.99 median vs $4.99 exclusive

64.5%

of multi-platform titles
PS is the cheapest platform



PLAYER ENGAGEMENT

Steam = Breadth. PlayStation = Depth.

STEAM

148.9

avg games owned

0.96

achievements per game

Library hoarders

PLAYSTATION

58.2

avg games owned

1.69

achievements per game

Deep engagers

XBOX

46.1

avg games owned

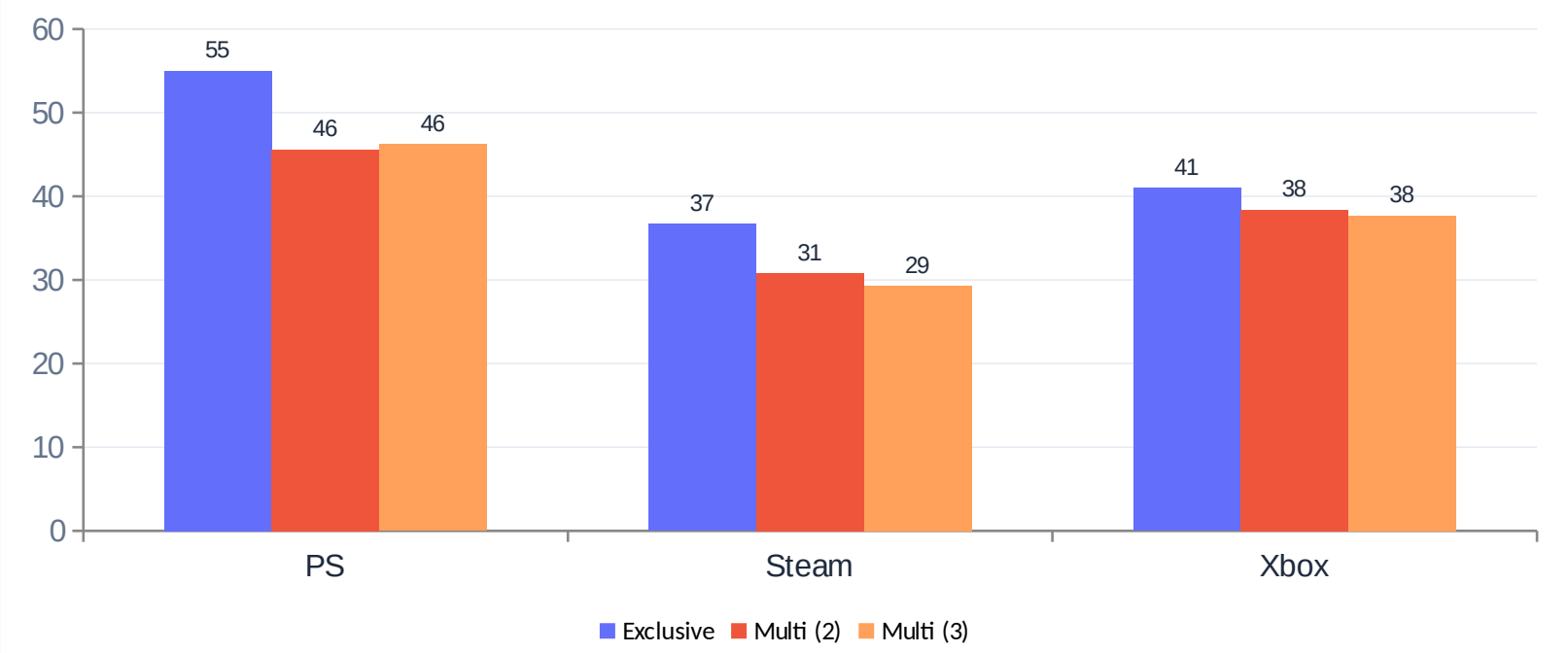
1.37

achievements per game

Balanced players

ACHIEVEMENT COMPLETION

Exclusives win on every platform



TEMPORAL TRENDS

COVID boosted everyone. Xbox is declining.

2020

COVID bump
across all platforms

−34%

Xbox decline
2021 → 2024

2.4M

Steam 2018 spike
peak unlocks

PS exclusive players engage 85% deeper than Steam exclusive (420.9 vs 228.1 avg achievements)

GEOGRAPHIC DISTRIBUTION

Where you live predicts how you play

REGIONAL PREFERENCES

Spain	91% PlayStation
Russia	Flips to Steam majority
US	#1 market overall
Germany	Strong PS + Steam mix

DEEPEST ENGAGEMENT

8 of top 10

deepest-engaging markets
are PlayStation

Estonia · Hong Kong · Czechia
Small markets, deep players

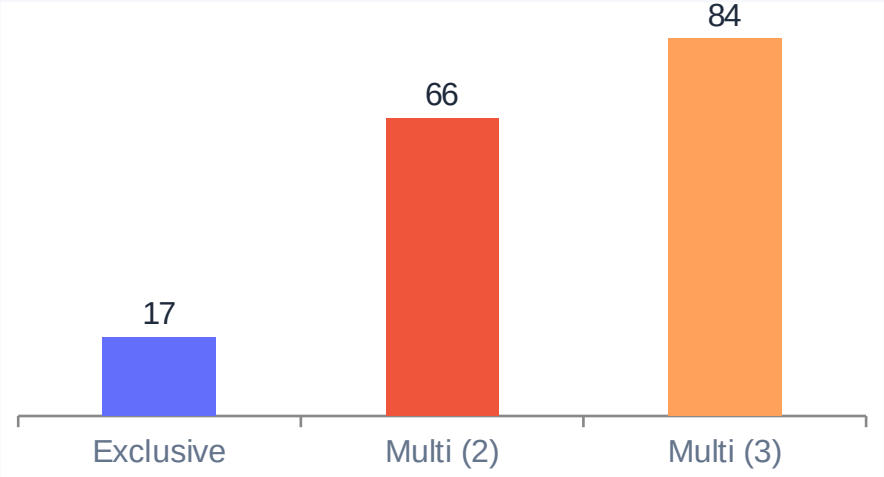
⚠️ Xbox has no country field — geographic analysis covers PS + Steam only

REVIEW SIGNALS

Multi-platform games get 5× more reviews

5×

more reviews per game
83.9 vs 17.4 for exclusives



RPG genres dominate helpfulness rankings. **Steam only** — reviews don't exist on PS/Xbox.

MACHINE LEARNING VALIDATION

Three models confirm the patterns are real

RANDOM FOREST

Supervised

Genre diversity is the top predictor of multi-platform status

LOGISTIC REGRESSION

Supervised

All coefficients positive — more genres, higher price, more platforms → multi

K-MEANS CLUSTERING

Unsupervised

Natural clusters align with exclusive-vs-multi divide without labels

Stats proved patterns → RF showed drivers → LR showed direction → K-Means confirmed structure

KEY FINDINGS

What the data tells us — the business story

85.5%

of games are platform-exclusive. Multi-platform is the exception, not the rule.

3×

price premium for multi-platform games. Median $14.99 vs $4.99 for exclusives.

55%

achievement completion for PS exclusives — highest of any platform × strategy combination.

5×

more reviews per game for multi-platform titles on Steam. Visibility begets visibility.

85%

deeper engagement for PS exclusive players vs Steam (420.9 vs 228.1 achievements).

91%

of Spanish players are on PS. Geography predicts platform preference and engagement.

THE SYNTHESIS

Thesis confirmed: Multi = Reach, Exclusive = Depth

High Depth ↑

↓ Low Depth

🎯 NICHE DEPTH

PS Exclusive
55% completion
46K players

⭐ IDEAL (RARE)

Multi-platform
29–46% completion
~46K per platform

❌ AVOID

Xbox Exclusive
38.4% completion
46.2K players

📢 VOLUME PLAY

Steam Exclusive
36.7% completion
46.8K players

← Low Reach

High Reach →

THE RECOMMENDATION

IF YOUR GOAL IS REACH

Go multi-platform (2+ platforms)

Price at market rate (~$15 median)

Expect 5× more reviews on Steam

Each platform adds ~46K players

IF YOUR GOAL IS DEPTH

Go PlayStation exclusive

55% achievement completion rate

Exclusives > multi on every platform

Target small EU markets for depth

The reach-depth tradeoff is structural. Multi-platform dilutes per-player engagement while maximizing total audience.

LIMITATIONS & FUTURE WORK

KNOWN LIMITATIONS

- Reviews are Steam-only
- No revenue data exists
- Title-based matching (no shared ID)
- Xbox has no country field
- 54.2% Steam NULL libraries excluded
- Pre-aggregated completion rates

FUTURE WORK

- NLP sentiment on review text
- Time-series forecasting (Xbox decline)
- Price elasticity modeling
- Genre-level deep dive
- Causal analysis: multi → visibility?

Thank you.

One person. One dataset. Six dimensions.
A testable thesis with a concrete answer.

TECH STACK

BigQuery · Python · Pandas · Plotly · scipy · scikit-learn

REPO

github.com/workintechpoyrazaka-sketch/gaming-platforms-synthesis